

Adobe Lightroom 1.0

The Darkroom For Your Digicam

Adobe's Lightroom is made for professional photographers as the darkroom alternative for new-age digital-camera-armed photographers. Lightroom falls into a new category—image post-production software, with its only and closest rival being Apple's Aperture. Lightroom does not come with most of Photoshop's features like layers, tools, and effects. In fact, though it is an image editing tool, Lightroom looks nothing like Photoshop.

Quick Develop in the Library module lets you make basic changes to an image in a matter of seconds. We used some photos of some wildlife taken in broad daylight to see how well the software's results would be. An auto-tune feature sets the best parameters for a photo, which should be suitable for new users, but we found the results rather appalling. Manual altering of colour

levels worked perfectly well, and is the best way to go.

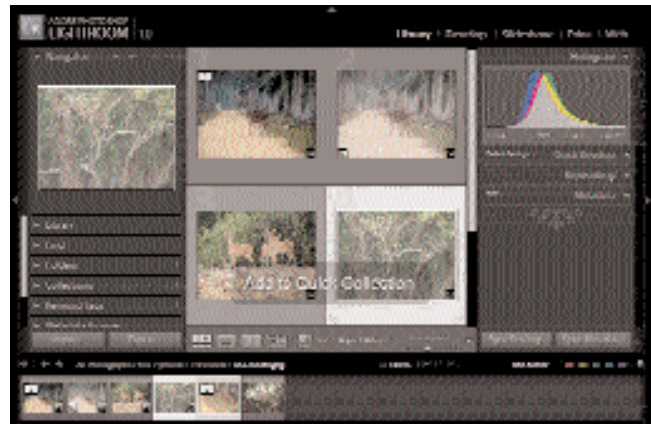
A metadata browser in Lightroom makes sorting and categorising large numbers of images effortlessly by EXIF parameters such as camera, lens, date, etc. Keyword stamping lets users easily set keywords to images.

The Develop mode—the core of the entire program—has plenty of filters and colour alteration features. The Before and After view is a good added feature; it helps users keep track of their progress.

Exporting of galleries to a Web format using HTML or Flash is done using the Web module.

A program called Adobe Photo Downloader acts as a monitor, looking for new media on external storage devices and cameras.

Documentation is good in terms of explanation, but has few screenshots. Memory consumption spiked from 3



MB when minimised to 54 MB with the program active, which is pretty good.

The Image Viewer features such as full-screen view mode are missing in Lightroom. Other than that, there is no shortage of features. Similar results can be achieved using Photoshop, but Lightroom's

interface and workflow are best suited for post-processing work for photographs. Those who would like to have Adobe Photoshop will have to shell out a minimum of \$649. Lightroom's \$199 (Rs 9,000) price tag is still pretty hefty for casual home users, but professional photographers would find the money well spent.

Contact: Adobe India
Phone: 0120-2444711
E-mail: sandeepm@adobe.com
Web site: www.adobe.com
Price: \$199 (Rs 9,000)

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Ease of use	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Site Studio 6 Pro

Template-based Web Designing

Site Studio 6 from Effective Studios is a Web designing tool that comes into an arena dominated by Adobe's Dreamweaver. It therefore has a lot to prove.

During installation, a video tutorial along with a voiceover is provided to explain some of the features. The interface of the program is pretty decent, with big icons on the toolbar.

You can create a Web page using one of the ready-made templates. The previews and the templates are hosted on the Net, so

there is some waiting time involved. The problem, of course, comes in when there's no Internet connection available.

Text styles can be altered, and new ones can be created from scratch. You can add external images into the library of Site Studio 6. Images can be resized for the Web before importing. Multiple colour schemes for projects are available to choose from. If you aren't pleased with the results, you can manually select colours for the various elements of your site.

There is no way to view the source for your Web pages; modifying the source has to be done using an external editor.

The documentation has plenty of images and steps.



You can choose to upload created pages or sites to an FTP server or to a local disk with a click of a button.

The entire program is set around templates, so you don't have to do the

dirty work of coding. It's therefore very simple software in terms of features, and that's what makes it easy to use—even those who just use word processing software will feel right at home. The price, however, isn't very simple: Site Studio 6 Pro is priced at \$389 (Rs 17,500). In comparison, Dreamweaver retails at \$399, for which you get a lot more, but with a lot of added complexity as well. Site Studio 6 Pro would then be best suited for when what's needed is software that is quick, hassle-free, and requires no knowledge of—or experience with—Web designing.

Contact: Effective Studios
Phone: NA
E-mail: john.houssels@effectivestudios.com
Web site: www.effectivestudios.com
Price: \$389 (Rs 17,500)

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Features	★★★★☆
Ease of use	★★★★☆
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